

(Kiwi 1 of 1)

Naomi Osaka's claim about prioritizing living in the moment and not getting caught in how far one has come is valid and as a society we need to start living this way. When everyone gets caught up in how far they have come they become almost drone like, living only to get more accomplishments rather than earning accomplishments from living.

Being caught up in the moment is dangerous and can make one lose sight of what it was all truly for. In our society famous athletes forget to be present for all of their competitions and are instead thinking about the next one rather than celebrating the current one. This turns into a cycle and if they do not notice before long they will look up and their life has gone by without them mentally being there. An example of this is Naomi Osaka and how in tennis it is easy to be thinking about the next match and to never lose focus of getting a grand slam, but it is also important to live in the moment and enjoy the fact that she has opportunities such as playing at the national level, while also making sure not to get caught up in it.

Some argue that living in the moment makes one lose sight of the big picture and instead makes them unprepared for the future and only focused on today and not the problems of the future; however, living in the moment also helps decrease burn out and can have the opposite effect of that claim. Instead of losing sight of the big picture, living in the moment causes one to be able to plan for the future without getting caught up in what the future has to look like. Another reason living in the moment is important is because if we do not our society will be full of mindless drones that are only focused on the next trophy and not on earning that trophy through blood, sweat, and tears.

In conclusion, Naomi Osaka's claim about how it is easy to lose sight of how far one has come and it is important to be present in each moment and by living in the moment one will enjoy the journey is valid and our society needs to start living by this before it is too late and it ends up being a society where success is measured in trophies and not in the moments it took to get to earning them.

## Banana (1 of 1)

Be happy because you're sad. It may seem like unorthodox advice, but it made sense to me as my life's journey progressed. It doesn't mean you should be glad something awful happened to you, it means to be happy you recognize your emotions. The easiest way to do that, as Osaka said, is to be present in each moment; without being present in the present, you can't fully recognize yourself and be happy in life.

We can only ever exist in the present, so why is it that we concern ourselves with the past or the future? It really seems pointless to worry about something that's not now. I definitely worried for this exam I'm taking right now, but now that it is now, and I'm taking this exam, I feel fine. It's because I'm living in the moment, I press each key with passion. I chose to take AP English Language not because I worried it would be a stressor in the future, which it hasn't nearly as much, but because I enjoy writing and finding truth in the subtext. I'm able to extract enjoyment even from a stressful exam by living here and now, putting my ideas into text. It's the same for any exam. As for the past, when I've worried about it, it has only made the present moment worse for me. A question I got wrong on a test, a time I lost something sentimental. It's only made me worry more if I thought about it. In breaking that cycle, I had to live in the moment. I went on more walks, talked with my friends more, payed attention in class more, and it payed off. Now I feel confident in my abilities, and I'm proud I've pulled myself out of a pit. Living in the moment is truely some of the best advice I've gotten and can give.

I had often lost track of how far I've come. At the beginning of middle school, 5th grade, I was consistently getting bad grades. Cs, Ds, and the rare F, at least from what I can remember right now. But now I'm here. I often get As and hardly ever get lower than a B. Soon enough I'll be in college. It's thanks to advice like this: living in the moment, that I've gotten here. I'm happy now because I was sad then, because now I know how much it changed me for the better, and now I feel confident in where I stand in my journey.

Don't get me wrong, though, you should still plan for the future. You should still reconcile with the past. They're important, but not nearly as much as the present. It's like a shopping trip. The past is important because that's when you realized you needed to go shopping in the first place, and the future holds importance, because you going on that grocery run or clothing run will make you better fed or well dressed, and your future will inevitably be better. But it's in the present, when you go shopping, that you'll find enjoyment. Because when you focus on that shopping trip in the present, not only are you looking for what you need, but you may also pick up a few things you want, or didn't know you wanted, and that'll definitely put a smile on your face. This is true for any point in life: any trip, any test, any friendship, any relationship, and step in your journey. Live in the moment and there'll be nothing to regret.

Cherry (1 of 1)

Consider, if you will, the concept of time. The past, present, and future are all important aspects of our chronological existence. According to a 2022 interview with *People* magazine promoting her program to empower young girls through sport, professional tennis player and mental health advocate Naomi Osaka claims that "For me, the biggest lesson I've learned is to try to be present in each moment. It's easy to lose sight of how far you've come, but I've been prioritizing trying to live in the moment and enjoy the journey."

However, we are never actually in the present, due to our brain processing information only milliseconds slower than our eyes. Thus, what does it truly mean to live in the present?

Living in the present can mean different things depending on your philosophy, but it most closely describes the feeling of fulfillment. Since your time on Earth is limited, you should not be wasting it; instead witnessing all the wonders and beauty it holds. Instead of staying inside all day, go outside to enjoy nature. Instead of turning down your friends invitation to go hiking, take them up on the offer and try something new. Doctors have scientifically proven that natural sunlight provides a chemical stimulant that improves your mental wellbeing and spending time with friends can improve relationships and bring you closer to the ones you love.

## Lemon (1 of 1)

In our current time, we fixate on doing things quickly and moving on to the next. Whether this is through scrolling on social media or from advertisements telling you to "Buy Now!". Osaka argues against this mentality as she believes it is better to live in the present moment. This is true as we rely heavily on social media and we could miss out on very important moments in our lives.

Social Media has given us the idea that we need to do things quickly or we will fall behind. Social Media takes up a large portion of people's time as it is used for both entertainment and connecting with friends. The entertainment portion of it is more dangerous as it has been progressively leaning towards quick hits of dopamine over anything else. This is most completely seen with the rise of scrolling whether it is through Youtube shorts, Tik Tok, or Instagram Reels, the primary way for entertainment has become quick short videos. These videos change our brain to crave the quick hits of dopamine that it provides as if you don't find a video funny you could easily just scroll to the next video and watch it. However, These quick hits of dopamine don't exist in the real world as you need to work for the dopamine which makes people want to do things faster so they can feel the dopamine. The prevalence of the short and quick entertainment makes it so this is not just a single person's issue but cultural one.

By only caring about doing things quick, you will lose the most important moments of your life. There are many times in life when something takes time to happen. It takes quite a long time for us to be able to walk or speak and when we finally do they are important moments for both you and your parents. These moments can be missed if you only care about doing things quick as they are moments that require a lot of build up and dedication but are truly rewarding at the end. There are many things that require you to actively pursue to gain. Whether its getting physically fit, working on your education, or writing your book, they all require a lot of time. Yet, when you finish them you are greatly happy as you conquered the challenge but you would never get it if you just focused on the next hit of dopamine. You would need to live in the present moment to feel it, to see your accomplishments and feel glad at what you have done.

You should not rely on Social Media for entertainment or dopamine as you could lose many opportunities and moments. It is best to live in the present moment and enjoy what you have achieved.

Mental health has been at the forefront of modern medicine and the center of discussion in the 21st century. There have been many half-minded ideas and antidotes of how to cure depression and anxiety. Throughout this all, there has been one common theme embedded in every supposed cure: live in the moment. Although planning for a future is important, living in the moment and enjoying the journey can be pivotal in helping with mental illness.

Being present in every moment and prioritizing the here and now can change one's mindset and help with anxiety. In the novel *Into the Wild*, Chris McCandless finds himself frustrated with the mundaneness of everyday life and the superficialness of people and higher education. The day after his graduation he leaves to hike around America and meet new people without being tethered to responsibilities. In the years leading to his death, he meets extraordinary people and goes on extraordinary adventures. This method lead him to feel free and content for the first time in years. This lifestyle is extreme and in many cases unnecessary but the message rings true. Focusing on the future - education, jobs, money - can lead to prioritizing the wrong things. McCandless would have never had so many amazing experiences without experiencing life without any reservations. Furthermore, if he had been thinking about the future his entire journey he might have taken his experience for granted and overlooked the beauty of nature in America. It is still important to look ahead and take into account things one cares about. But, many times, people go too far in this direction and lose sight of what really matters. Jay Gatsby, for example, in *The Great Gatsby* spent his entire life pining for a woman and building a fortune on illegal money in order to win her. Upon seeing Daisy for the first time since they were split apart in a war, they find that they are not, in fact, the perfect fit. Their relationship was awkward and off-kilter. Gatsby did prioritize love which is a noble thing, but this love fell the more time they spent apart from each other and was replaced with obsession. He devoted himself entirely to the idea of a perfect woman. Some may say Chris McCandless threw his life away and the only thing he got from it was an untimely death. But, Jay Gatsby also died young and went surrounded by a mansion and material goods he never cared about. Death is inevitable, and at least McCandless lived his last years in a lifestyle he found fit for himself, free of burdens.

Similarly, in the movie *Perks of Being a Wallflower*, a boy with severe childhood trauma and mental illness becomes friends with a group of teenagers who define the meaning of the term "live in the moment". Through spontaneous parties, dancing, and other activities, the boy finds his PTSD symptoms fade and his loneliness ebb. He becomes infatuated with his new friends and because of this, spends less time thinking of other things. Living in the moment had the opposite effect on him. Instead of curing him from anxiety about the future, it helped him overcome trauma from the past. Also, in the novel/movie *The Fault in Our Stars*, Poppy Grace, a girl with terminal cancer spends most of her teenage years in her house alone, until she meets a boy who introduces her to a new friend group and a new life. This new lifestyle had a similar effect as on the boy from *Perks of Being a Wallflower* as it showed her a new world of possibilities. The cancer never went away, it never would in the first place, but through living in the moment she was able to have amazing experiences like going to Amsterdam and having a boyfriend. This lifestyle of risks and opportunities resulted in a much more content state of mind. She began to realize that taking risks to her health and being carefree was much more fulfilling than sitting at home everyday ruminating on her immanent death.

Time spent on earth is limited, this is something Poppy Grace and Chris McCandless knew very well. Constantly looking to something else results in a lack of appreciation for the world around you. There is no need to rush an already short period of time, it will only bring on unnecessary stress and anxiety.

# Tangerine (1 of 1)

To the extent of Naomi Osaka's interview with People magazine, I ultimately agree with Osaka's claim on embracing the present moment. With this claim from Osaka, she believes that living in the moment and enjoying the journey no matter what comes your way life, is the right way to go about things. This is a great point coming from such a major athlete, also mental health advocate Osaka, because of her path and what she has gone through as an athlete.

This claim about embracing the present moment is one that many may not agree with because of how hard it is to do. With many being left stuck on remembering bad moments in the past, whether it be in sports or life in general, it is hard to overcome a mental setback of that caliber. With this, the validation throughout Osaka's entire claim is completely true. Osaka also explains how you can lose sight of how far you have come because of these mental obstacles. People often fall victim to this with many setting goals and working hard to reach them, but when they accomplish what they want in the future, they feel like they have done nothing. They feel they have gotten nowhere, even though where they are now is somewhere they would have only dreamed of being at back then.

Osaka concludes her interview by stating that you need to enjoy the journey, something that she has been prioritizing. Enjoying the journey is something that everyone struggles with because you can have things go both good and bad, but no matter what happens, you should always enjoy what you are doing and often think about how far you have come and where you are now. These examples of mental encouragement from Osaka are a big reason the position on her claim is completely valid throughout her interview.